

THE GUNS



▲ AT THE NOSE

The bombardier had a clear view of the target through the plexiglass nose. He also operated the twin .5in Browning M2 machine-guns in the chin turret below, by remote control.

▲ CHIN GUN

A chin turret was added on the B-17G after research showed that the plane was vulnerable to head-on attacks.



◀ DORSAL TURRET

The forward dorsal guns were mounted above the cockpit in a hydraulically powered turret with 360° traverse and 90° elevation; they were operated by the flight engineer.



▲ CHEEK GUN

Single flexibly mounted M2 machine-guns were mounted just aft of the bombardier's position; they were operated by the navigator.



▲ BALL TURRET

The F and G variants featured a ventral (ball) turret that was suspended on a gimbal from a tube attached to the fuselage ceiling.



▲ WAIST GUN

Along the fuselage in staggered positions, port (aft) and starboard (forward), were single, flexibly mounted M2s, each with its own gunner.

◀ A MIGHTY FORTRESS

With a ten-man crew, the B-17 was cramped, but its crews set great store by its ability to get them home even when badly damaged.

